the capable group comprising families of recovering drug dependents. Wives, mothers, fathers, husbands and adolescents have been encouraged to provide help and support. This was perhaps the first such group of its kind. Nayjyoti has now become the most recognized treatment centre in India and has bagged several national and international awards, including the highly respected Serge Sotiroff Award instituted by the United Nations.

Gradually, Kiran's Nayjyoti incorporated other crime prevention programmes to reach out to vulnerable sections of society through the education of street/slum children by establishing over 200 single-teacher schools, apart from setting up vocational training for women prisoners, slum women, the rural poor, adolescents and the disabled, as well as health-care and counselling centres. The organization, with a staff of over 350 professionals, reaches out daily to no less than 10,000 underprivileged persons – men, women and children – living among the marginalized sections of society. It does so through more than 50 projects including a Doordarshan (the government-run TV channel) serial *Galti Kiski*. Her projects enjoy overwhelming support of both the Government of India and the international community. Kiran supervises the work of the foundation as its general secretary.

Kiran's thirst for community welfare can apparently never be quenched! On receiving the Ramon Magsaysay Award in 1994, she founded another organization called the India Vision Foundation. This foundation's primary focus areas are the education of prisoners' children and prison reforms. Today, the organization provides education with residential schooling and home visits to over 300 children of prisoners. It also supports and collaborates with Nayjyoti in running slum and rural schools, also called *gali* schools, apart from *balwarees* (crèches), vocational training units in prisons, family counselling centres and organizing camps for disabled persons in rural areas. The Tihar Jail (while Kiran was its inspector general) got its bread-making unit and a polygreen house through a corpus fund started with a part of the award money won by the India Vision Foundation. Since then even her second foundation has grown and diversified into many more supportive roles in the field of community welfare, particularly in the rural areas. On land donated partly by her parents and sisters and partly by herself, the foundation has a very beautiful Rural Development Community Centre on the outskirts of Delhi, built with Norwegian support. (For more details on her community work, one can visit her two very interesting and informative websites: www.indiavisionfoundation.org and www.drughelpline.org, besides her own website, www.kiranbedi.org.)

Kiran remains eager to take up each assignment with a missionary zeal. And she stands totally dedicated to both her organizations. She presently attends to the numerous details of each assignment from anywhere within the country or outside, thanks to remarkable gadgets such as the mobile phone, the e-mail and the Internet. She devotes whatever personal time she has – including weekends and holidays – to organizational work. All royalties from her books and columns are donated to her foundations. And that is where she goes beyond herself.

This is how Kiran has shaped her life. Had it not been this way, her community welfare work would not have grown and expanded to the extent it has. Such total commitment to missions that are beyond the call of duty are certainly rare for any police officer. But Kiran is one who goes beyond herself, willingly and lovingly, all the time.